

THE BASE RATE

One In Three New Startups Is Solo Founded

Carta data says solo founders went from 23.7% of new ventures in 2019 to 36.3% by mid-2025. I used to think I was the exception.

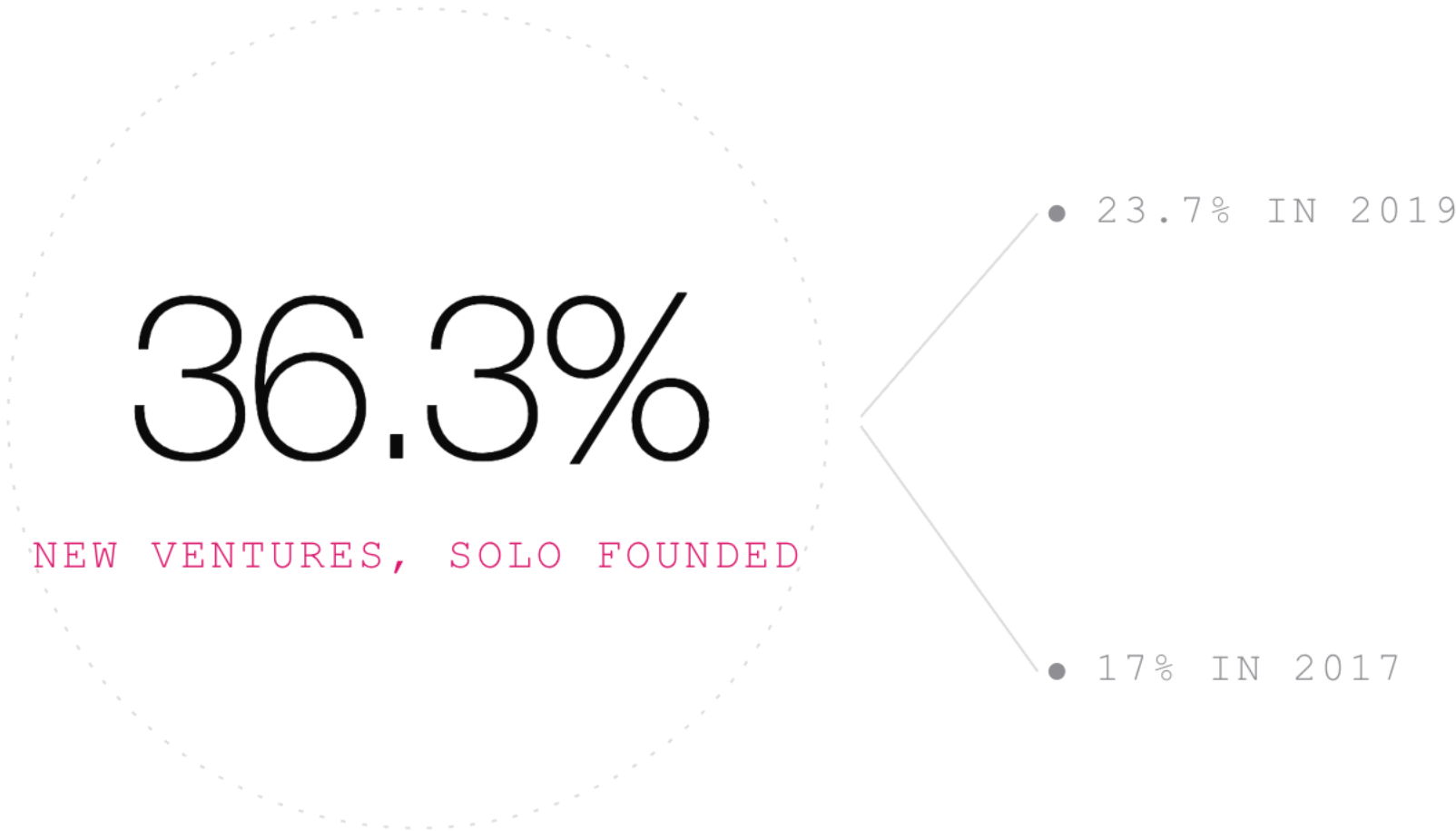
UNROLL THE DRAWING

SECTION 02 · CARTA, MID-2025

36.3% Of New Ventures, Solo Founded

Carta, reported by Forbes: solo-founded startups rose from 23.7% of all new ventures in 2019 to 36.3% by mid-2025. More than double 2017's 17%.

FIG. 2



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SECTION 03 · CLOUD 24 ERA

The Bottleneck Used To Be Hiring

At Cloud 24, growth meant finding the right person, training them, managing handoffs. Slow, and the wrong hire cost more than doing it myself.

FIG. 3

IND THE HIRE



T0

T1

TRAIN THEM

MANAGE
HANDOFFS

T2

T3

HOPE THEY STAY

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SECTION 04 · CONTEXT ENGINEERING

Now The Skill Is Context, Not Prompts

Anyone can write a good prompt. The real skill is building the information systems that keep an agent reliable across a full week.

FIG. 4



ONE PROMPT, ONE OUTPUT

PASS



CONTEXT SYSTEM, FULL WEEK

PASS



STAYS RELIABLE DAY THREE

PASS



HOLDS THROUGH DAY SIX

LIVE

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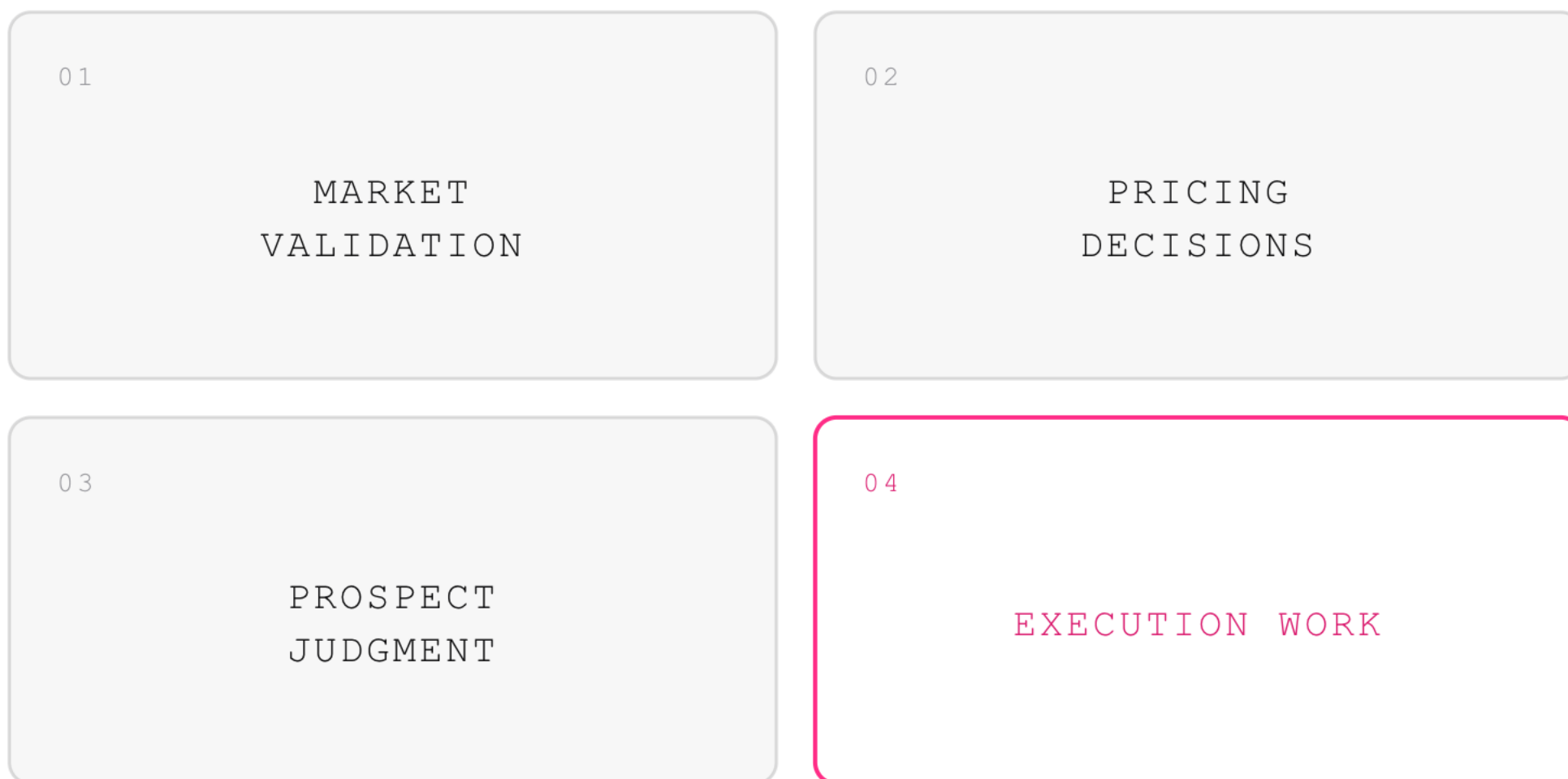
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SECTION 05 · STILL HUMAN

What Agents Still Can't Do

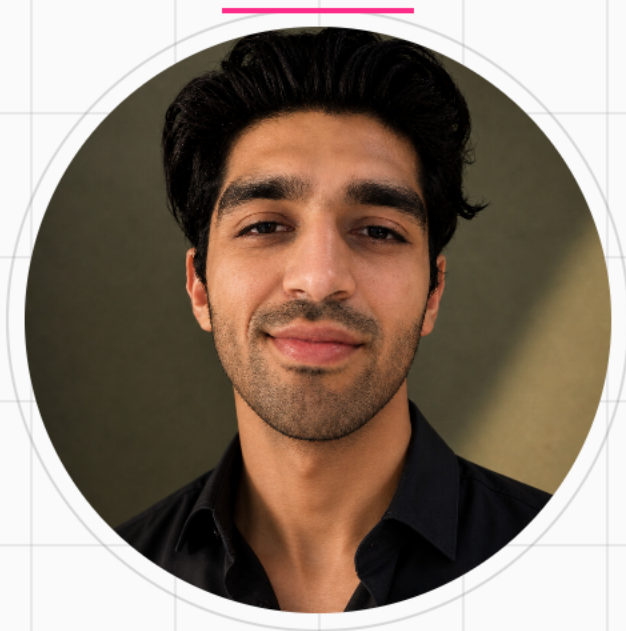
They can't validate whether a market actually wants this, and they can't set pricing or judge which prospect is worth chasing.

FIG. 5



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The Bottleneck Moved. Has Yours?

Execution used to require a team. Now it requires the right context system.

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